

into the river Tigris. The Tigris, after receiving the Gyndes, flows on by the city of Opis,⁸ and discharges its waters into the Erythræan sea. When Cyrus reached this stream, which could only be passed in boats, one of the sacred white horses accompanying his march, full of spirit and high mettle, walked into the water, and tried to cross by himself; but the current seized him, swept him along with it, and drowned him in its depths. Cyrus, enraged at the insolence of the river, threatened so to break its strength that in future even women should cross it easily without wetting their knees. Accordingly he put off for a time his attack on Babylon, and, dividing his army into two parts, he marked out by ropes one hundred and eighty trenches on each side of the Gyndes, leading off from it in all directions, and setting his army to dig, some on one side of the river, some on the other, he accomplished his threat by the aid of so great a number of hands, but not without losing thereby the whole summer season.

190. Having, however, thus wreaked his vengeance on the Gyndes⁹ by dispersing it through three hundred and sixty chan-

banks of the Zamacân before it joins the Diyâlah, and before the united rivers issue from the mountains into the plain of *Shahrizûr*.

[It must be confessed, however, that *Darneh* has not been a place of any consequence either in the ancient or modern geography of the country. It was merely selected by the Kurdish emirs for their residence about five centuries back on account of the strength of the position. *Δαρδάνεοι* may very well mean "the holders of the passes," and thus exactly apply to the tribes along the banks of the upper *Diyâlah*.—H. C. R.]

⁸ This is the plain meaning of Herodotus, who has therefore been accused of ignorance by Rennell (*Geography of Herod.* § 9, p. 202). But the situation of Opis is uncertain. Strabo, by calling it an emporium (xvi. p. 1051) might lead us to imagine that its position was low down the river. Xenophon's narrative (*Anab.* ii. iv. 13-25), it must be granted, makes this impossible. Still, however, Opis may have been a little below the junction of the Diyâlah with the Tigris, or at the point of confluence.

[If we remember that Xenophon's Median Wall is the enceinte of Babylon, and that the Greeks crossed the Tigris at Sittacé, which was on the road from Babylon to Susa, we can hardly fail of identifying the *Diyâlah* with the Phycus of Xenophon (*Anab.* ii. iv. 25), and thus recognising Opis in the ruins of *Khafaji*, near the confluence of the two rivers. The name of Phycus probably comes from *Hupuska*, the title in the inscriptions of the district of *Sulimanieh*, through which the Diyâlah flows. In the name of Opis we have probably a Greek nominative ending as in *Is*. The cuneiform orthography is *Hupiya*, and I rather think that *Khafaji* is a mere corruption of the original name. The name of Sittacé, or, more properly, Psittacé, is written in the inscriptions as *Patsita*, without the Scythic guttural termination. It appears to have been situated at least as low down as the modern fort of the Zobeid chief.—H. C. R.]

⁹ Rennell sensibly remarks (p. 202) that the story of Cyrus's dividing the Gyndes is a very childish one, *in the manner in which it is told*. He supposes that the river was swollen, and that the sole object of Cyrus was to effect the passage. But this explanation is unsatisfactory. It is not conceivable that Cyrus proceeded against Babylon unprepared for the passage of great rivers. Boats must have abounded on the streams, and rafts supported by inflated skins, which were in constant use upon